

GigVerse — Student Gig Marketplace

Project Overview

GigVerse is a full-stack freelance marketplace built specifically for students — think Fiverr/Upwork, but scoped to a campus/student audience. Students can offer paid services (design, writing, tutoring, development, etc.), post or bid on one-off jobs, chat in real time with clients or freelancers, and get AI-assisted job recommendations. It's built as a complete MVP demonstrating end-to-end product engineering: authentication, role-based access, real-time features, a relational database, and a deployable production architecture.

Who It's For

Two user roles:

- Freelancer (student): builds a profile with skills, lists services, browses and bids on jobs, chats with clients, gets paid, collects reviews.
- Client: posts jobs with a budget and deadline, reviews incoming bids, hires a freelancer, chats, pays, and leaves a review.

Core Features :

1.Authentication & Access

- Email/password signup and login with JWT-based sessions
- Passwords hashed with bcrypt
- Role-based route protection (Freelancer / Client / Admin)

Marketplace :

- Browse services with search, category, price, and rating filters
- Post jobs with a budget, deadline, and category

- Submit bids with a proposal, quote, and delivery estimate
- Accept/reject bids, which triggers the payment flow

Dashboards :

- Freelancer dashboard: profile summary, active services, submitted bids, active jobs, AI job recommendations
- Client dashboard: posted jobs, incoming bids, hired freelancers, payment history

Real-Time Chat :

- One-to-one messaging via Socket.io
- Typing indicators
- Optional file attachments

AI-Powered Matching :

- Rule-based "Job Matchmaker" — scores job/freelancer compatibility using a weighted formula (skills 40%, category 30%, rating 20%, experience 10%)
- Smart bid assistant that suggests a bid amount, delivery time, and proposal template

Reviews:

- 1–5 star ratings with written comments
- Aggregated onto user profiles